

Notes on Paragraph Writing

1. Composing Paragraphs

A paragraph is a group of related sentences that develop one main idea. It usually consists of a topic sentence, supporting sentences, and a concluding sentence. Effective paragraphs help to organize thoughts clearly and maintain focus on the main idea.

2. Methods of Paragraph Development

Different methods can be used to develop a paragraph, depending on the purpose. Some common methods include:

1. Narration: Telling a story or recounting events.
2. Description: Using sensory details to describe a person, place, or thing.
3. Exemplification: Providing examples to support the main idea.
4. Comparison and Contrast: Highlighting similarities and differences between ideas.
5. Cause and Effect: Explaining the reasons something happens or the results of an event.
6. Process: Describing the steps in a process.
7. Definition: Providing a detailed explanation of a term or concept.
8. Classification: Grouping similar items or ideas into categories.

3. Topic Sentence

The topic sentence expresses the main idea of the paragraph. It is usually the first sentence but can appear elsewhere in the paragraph. A strong topic sentence helps guide the reader by setting the direction for the paragraph.

4. Cohesion and Coherence in Paragraph Writing

Cohesion refers to the use of linguistic devices to connect ideas within a paragraph. Coherence refers to the overall clarity and logical flow of ideas. Ensuring both cohesion and coherence is essential for writing effective paragraphs.

4.1 Jumbled Sentences and Paragraphs

Jumbled sentences and paragraphs exercises involve reorganizing scrambled sentences into a coherent paragraph. This practice helps learners to understand how to structure ideas

logically. It also enhances their ability to identify cohesive devices that connect ideas within the text.

5. Lexical Bundles as Coherence Markers

Lexical bundles are recurrent sequences of words that often occur together in texts. They act as coherence markers, helping to link sentences and ideas. Examples of lexical bundles include: "on the other hand," "as a result of," and "in addition to." Using these bundles appropriately can improve the coherence of a paragraph.

6. Practice in Paragraph Writing

Effective paragraph writing requires practice. Exercises in composing paragraphs, rearranging jumbled sentences, and identifying coherence markers help improve writing skills. We should focus on developing clear topic sentences, using relevant supporting details, and ensuring logical flow through cohesion and coherence devices.